Although I have not personally refinanced, I found a few *Creative Savings* readers who've already been through the process. Here's their advice:

> *We refinanced last year and that cut over $100 off our monthly payment! It was just in time since I am now a SAHM mom. We aim to make one extra payment a year, oftentimes using our tax refund to do so.*
>
> — *Kristen, joyfullythriving.com*

> *We refinanced two years ago. We refinanced to the same term (30-year), but saved 2.25% interest and shaved $215 off our monthly payment. We're investing the savings to build a home in a few years.*
>
> — *Allison, MI*

> *We refinanced to a 15-year so we could save tens of thousands on interest and finish paying before we retired.*
>
> — *Amy, TX*

4. HAVE YOUR PROPERTY REASSESSED

During the financial crisis of 2008, housing prices dropped considerably, triggering a domino effect that also lowered tax values. For those of us who have taxes included in our mortgage (also known as an escrow account), there's a good chance you can lower your monthly payment just by having your home reassessed.

Private companies offer these assessments for a fee, but it's actually quite easy to do yourself. Find a realtor to run "comps" on houses in your area, and compare those numbers to your home's last assessed value. You can usually find this on your county's website under *property appraiser*. If the current value is significantly lower, call your local tax assessor and have them send you a form to fill out with your findings. The office will then determine whether or not your home is worth reevaluating.